



Executive Committee of the National Security Council (ExComm)

*Agenda: At the Edge of Armageddon: Navigating Escalation, Deterrence, and
Survival amidst Soviet Missile Deployment in Cuba*

Freeze Date: 16th October, 1962

Introduction to the Committee

The Executive Committee of the National Security Council (ExComm) is not simply a council of advisors; it is the final barrier between fragile order and irreversible catastrophe. Convened by John F. Kennedy on October 16, 1962, this small, tightly held circle of power was thrust into a moment where history ceased to move gradually and instead lurched toward the brink. The discovery of Soviet nuclear missile installations in Cuba did not merely disturb the balance of the Cold War—it obliterated it. For the first time, the threat of nuclear war was no longer distant, abstract, or hypothetical. It was immediate. It was measurable in minutes. Entire cities—Washington, New York, Chicago, now existed under the shadow of sudden annihilation. The United States was forced into a decision space where every option risked not just escalation, but the end of civilization as it was known.

This is not diplomacy in its familiar form. There are no carefully staged summits, no extended negotiations cushioned by time and protocol. This is a war cabinet operating in its most primal state, urgent, uncertain, and relentlessly pressured. Within this room sit figures like Robert F. Kennedy, Robert McNamara, and Dean Rusk, men burdened not just with authority, but with consequence. They are not debating policy; they are determining survival. Every course of action, whether it is an airstrike, an invasion, or a blockade, carries within it the possibility of retaliation, misinterpretation, and uncontrollable escalation. There is no clean solution, no morally unambiguous path. Each decision is a calculated risk taken in the dark, with the knowledge that a single misstep could ignite a chain reaction no one can contain.

The environment you step into is defined by suffocating tension and relentless uncertainty. Intelligence arrives in fragments, grainy photographs, partial analyses, and conflicting assessments, never complete, never entirely reliable. Military commanders push for decisive, overwhelming force, convinced that hesitation invites weakness. Diplomats urge restraint, warning that one aggressive move could fracture alliances and provoke global backlash. Meanwhile, time itself becomes a silent adversary, compressing thought and forcing action before clarity can be achieved. Every passing hour brings the missiles in Cuba closer to operational readiness, tightening the window in which the United States can act without catastrophic consequence.

Hovering over all of this is Nikita Khrushchev, a leader whose bold and calculated gamble has placed the world on a knife's edge. His decision to deploy nuclear weapons into Cuba is not just a strategic manoeuvre; it is a direct challenge, a test of resolve, and a provocation that demands response. Yet his intentions remain obscured, are the missiles a defensive shield for Cuba, or the opening move in a broader confrontation? Misreading him could be as dangerous as confronting him.

Inside this room, there is no distance between decision and consequence. A directive issued here does not remain confined to paper, it moves fleets, mobilizes armies, and signals intentions across continents. It can trigger retaliation in Berlin, ignite conflict in Europe, or unleash nuclear fire across hemispheres. The margin for error is non-existent. The weight of responsibility is absolute. You are not simply participants in a discussion; you are the individuals upon whom the fate of millions rests.

There will be no perfect choices, only necessary ones. You will be forced to weigh aggression against restraint, speed against caution, and strength against survival. The world outside does not know what is unfolding within these walls, but it will live—or perish—by what you decide. History will not remember the fear in this room, nor the hesitation. It will remember the decisions. And in this moment, with the world balanced on the edge of destruction, those decisions are yours.

The ExComm now comes to order.

America's future now rests on your shoulders. Godspeed.



Agenda Overview

Agenda Title:

“At the Edge of Armageddon: Navigating Escalation, Deterrence, and Survival amidst Soviet Missile Deployment in Cuba”

The agenda before this committee—***“Strategic Response to the Deployment of Soviet Nuclear Missiles in Cuba”***—is not a question of policy refinement or diplomatic routine; it is a confrontation with the possibility of extinction. It demands not only an understanding of military strategy, nuclear doctrine, diplomatic manoeuvring, and intelligence assessment, but the ability to wield them under the crushing weight of time and consequence. Unlike conventional committees, where ideas are shaped, debated, and slowly polished into resolutions, ExComm exists in a state of permanent urgency. Here, decisions are not drafted, they are made. They are immediate, irreversible, and echo far beyond the walls of the White House. The presence of Soviet nuclear missiles in Cuba has shattered the illusion of distance that once protected the United States. The Atlantic Ocean is no longer a buffer. Warning times have collapsed from hours to minutes. The balance of terror has shifted, and with it, the margin for error has all but disappeared.

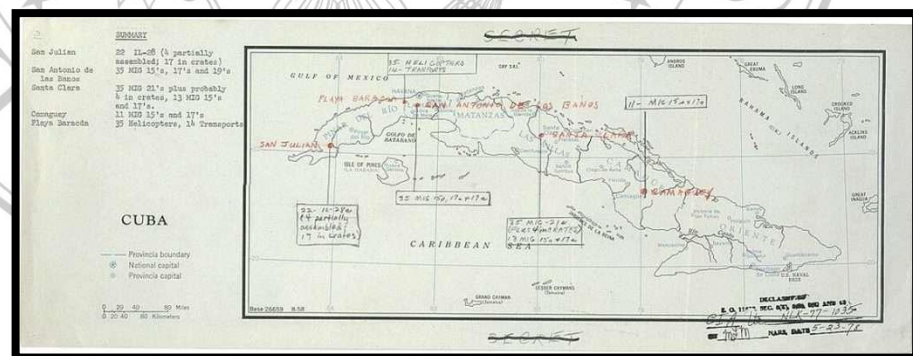
From the very outset, military considerations surge to the forefront, pressing upon delegates with relentless intensity. The options before you are stark, each one carrying the potential to either neutralize the threat or ignite a chain reaction of escalation. An airstrike promises swift and decisive action, an attempt to eliminate the missiles before they become operational, but it also risks being interpreted as an act of war, inviting Soviet retaliation not just in Cuba, but in flashpoints like Berlin, where tensions already simmer dangerously. A full-scale invasion of Cuba offers the illusion of control, a chance to remove the threat entirely through overwhelming

force, yet it opens the door to direct confrontation with the Soviet Union, potentially dragging the world into a global conflict that spirals beyond

containment. Then there is the naval

blockade, the so-called “quarantine”, a calculated display of power that seeks to halt further escalation without firing the first shot. But restraint carries its own dangers; it buys time for diplomacy, yes, but also for the enemy to prepare, entrench, and perhaps even complete the very threat you seek to prevent. Each path is lined with uncertainty. Each choice is a gamble with consequences measured not in policy outcomes, but in lives and cities.

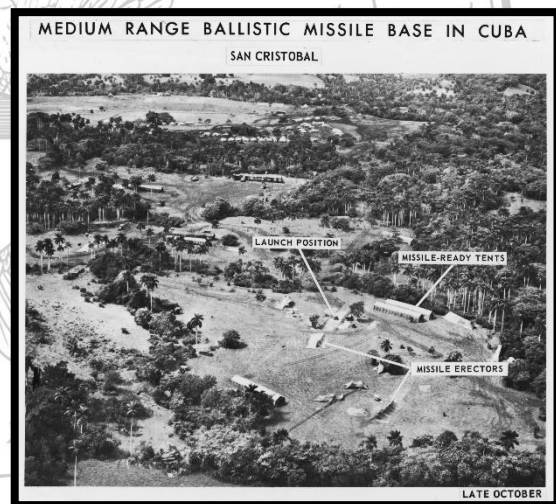
Hovering over every discussion, every calculation, is the inescapable shadow of nuclear war. The Cold War doctrine of Mutually Assured Destruction creates a chilling paradox: both



superpowers possess the capacity to annihilate each other completely, yet this very capability is what has thus far prevented open conflict. It is a balance maintained not by trust, but by fear. Delegates must now confront the terrifying possibility that this balance could collapse. What begins as a limited strike or a controlled escalation could rapidly spiral into full-scale nuclear exchange. The line between tactical and strategic weapons blurs under pressure. A single misinterpretation, a single unauthorized launch, a single moment of panic could unleash devastation on a scale the world has never seen. The decisions taken in this room will determine whether nuclear weapons remain silent instruments of deterrence, or become the fire that consumes everything.

Yet war is not fought in isolation, and the diplomatic dimension of this crisis is as volatile as the military one. The United States must navigate a fragile and complex international landscape, where every move is scrutinized and every action carries political weight. The United Nations becomes a stage for confrontation, where evidence is presented, accusations are made, and the battle for global opinion unfolds in real time. Allies within NATO look to Washington not just for protection, but for leadership and clarity, while adversaries search for signs of weakness or overreach. Non-aligned nations, caught between the superpowers, watch with growing unease, aware that the outcome of this crisis will shape the future of global politics. Behind the scenes, backchannel communications with Nikita Khrushchev may offer a fragile path toward de-escalation, but these secret exchanges are fraught with risk. A misread message, a delayed response, or a perceived slight could close the door to diplomacy entirely.

At the heart of every decision lies intelligence, imperfect, fragmented, and often contradictory. The initial discovery of missile sites through U-2 reconnaissance flights has provided undeniable evidence of the threat, but it has not provided certainty. How many missiles are there? Are they operational? Are there nuclear warheads already in place? What are the true intentions of the Soviet leadership? Delegates must sift through incomplete reports, challenge assumptions, and act without the comfort of full knowledge. In this environment, hesitation can be as dangerous as haste. Underestimating the threat could leave the nation vulnerable to attack, while overestimating it could provoke unnecessary escalation. The fog of intelligence is not just an obstacle, it is a constant presence, shaping and distorting every choice you make.



Compounding these pressures is the ever-present force of domestic politics, an invisible yet powerful influence on every decision. Though ExComm operates in secrecy, shielded from public view, the consequences of its actions will inevitably surface. The American public, Congress, and the broader political establishment will judge not only the outcome of this crisis, but the manner in which it was handled. Strength must be demonstrated, but recklessness must be avoided. Credibility must be preserved, but not at the cost of survival. The administration must project resolve to its adversaries while maintaining the confidence of its citizens. In a

democracy, even decisions of war are bound by perception, and perception itself can shape reality.

This agenda, therefore, is not a linear problem to be solved, but a storm to be navigated. It demands clarity in the face of confusion, courage in the face of fear, and judgment in the face of unimaginable stakes. Every second that passes brings the world closer to a tipping point. Every decision you make sends ripples across continents, across alliances, across the fragile fabric of global stability. There is no room for detachment, no space for complacency. You are not simply responding to a crisis, you are defining it. And in doing so, you hold in your hands the power to pull the world back from the brink... or to push it over the edge.



Message from the Chairperson

There are moments in history that are studied, debated, and remembered. And then there are moments that are *lived*, moments where the weight of the world does not rest in textbooks, but in the hands of a few individuals sitting in a single room. This committee is one such moment.

So, Delegates Delegates Delegates! WE HAVE AN UPDATE! Welcome to the Executive Committee of the National Security Council (ExComm).

You are no longer observers of history. You are now its authors.

On October 16, 1962, a small group of men gathered under the leadership of John F. Kennedy, faced with a reality so grave that even the strongest among them hesitated. Nuclear missiles had been discovered in Cuba. The distance between peace and annihilation had collapsed into minutes. And every decision that followed carried the possibility of ending not just a war—but the world itself.

As you step into this room, understand what you are stepping into.

This is not a committee of speeches, it is a committee of consequences.
This is not a forum of diplomacy, it is a crucible of decision-making.
This is not about being right, it is about being responsible.

You will be forced to make choices where every option is flawed. You will debate whether to strike or to wait, whether to escalate or to restrain, whether to act in strength or survive through caution. And in those moments, I want you to remember something that defines this crisis:

“The essence of ultimate decision remains impenetrable to the decider himself.”
— John F. Kennedy

You will not have perfect information. You will not have perfect clarity.
But you will still have to decide.

And that is what leadership truly is.

You are expected to embody not just your portfolio, but the burden it carries. Think like statesmen, act like strategists, and speak with the urgency of those who know that hesitation itself can be fatal. Challenge each other. Disrupt when necessary. Stand your ground when it matters. But above all—remain anchored in realism. This is not a world of fiction. Every action must feel possible. Every directive must feel real.

That is the line you walk.

Between wisdom and destruction.
Between control and chaos.
Between history and oblivion.

I will not ask you to be perfect.
I will not expect you to be fearless.

But I will expect you to *decide*.

Make bold choices—but make them believable.
Take risks—but understand their cost.
Lead—but remember what you are leading *towards*.

Because in this room, neutrality is an illusion. Inaction is a decision. And silence can be as dangerous as aggression.

As your Chairperson, I am not here merely to evaluate you—I am here to challenge you, to push you, and to immerse you in a simulation that demands everything you have. I want to see conviction. I want to see conflict. I want to see moments where the room falls silent—not because there is nothing to say, but because the weight of what has been said is too great to ignore.

The clock is ticking.
The missiles are being assembled.
The world is watching—whether it knows it or not.

And now, the future of this world rests in your hands.

Godspeed, delegates.

Contact us at: excomm.claromun26@gmail.com

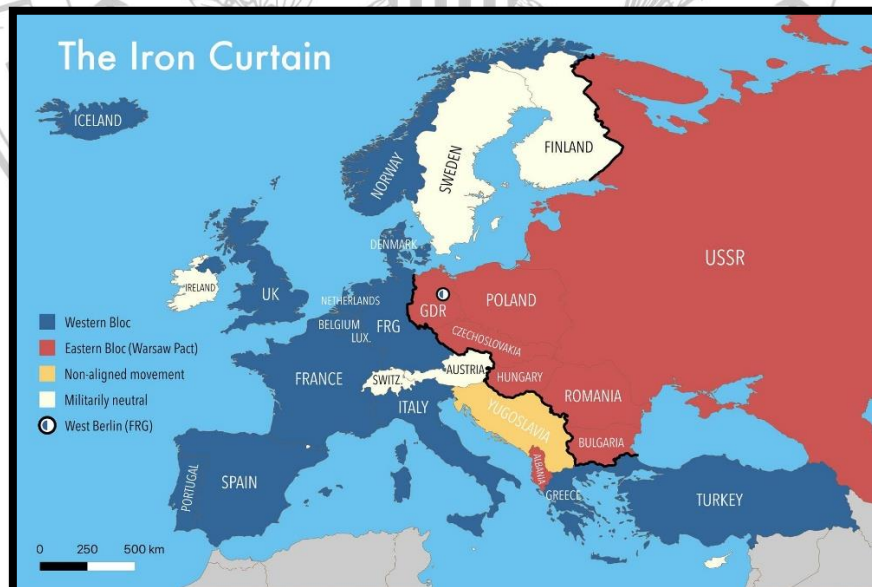
Warm regards,
Aditya Banik
Chairperson, Executive Committee of the National Security Council (ExComm)
ClaroMUN 2026

Historical Background: The Road to October 16, 1962

1. The Collapse of the Wartime Alliance and the Rise of the Cold War (1945–1949):

The origins of the Cuban Missile Crisis lie in the immediate aftermath of the Second World War, when the fragile alliance between the United States and the Soviet Union rapidly deteriorated into deep ideological hostility. The wartime unity that had defeated Nazi Germany was replaced by mutual suspicion, as both nations sought to shape the post-war world in fundamentally different ways. The United States championed liberal democracy and capitalist expansion, while the Soviet Union, under Joseph Stalin, consolidated a sphere of influence across Eastern Europe, installing communist governments in countries such as Poland, Hungary, and East Germany.

This division of Europe became symbolic of a broader global confrontation. Winston Churchill famously described it as an “Iron Curtain” descending across the continent, separating East from West. The first major flashpoint of this emerging Cold War was the Berlin Blockade. In an attempt to force Western powers out of Berlin, the Soviet Union blocked all land access to the city. The United States and its allies responded with the Berlin Airlift, supplying West Berlin entirely by air for nearly a year. While direct war was avoided, the crisis entrenched a pattern of confrontation, brinkmanship, and psychological warfare that would define the Cold War.



The formation of military alliances soon followed. NATO was established in 1949 as a collective defence pact among Western nations, while the Soviet Union would later respond with the Warsaw Pact. These alliances institutionalized the division of the world into opposing blocs, setting the stage for decades of tension and competition.

2. The Nuclear Arms Race and the Doctrine of Deterrence (1950s)

As political tensions escalated, both superpowers engaged in an intense and rapidly accelerating nuclear arms race. The United States initially held a monopoly on nuclear weapons, but the Soviet Union successfully tested its first atomic bomb in 1949, ending that advantage. What followed was a relentless competition to develop more powerful and more efficient weapons, including the hydrogen bomb, which was exponentially more destructive than earlier atomic devices.

By the mid-1950s, both nations had developed long-range bombers and intercontinental ballistic missiles (ICBMs) capable of delivering nuclear warheads across continents. The concept of nuclear deterrence began to take shape, evolving into the doctrine of Mutually Assured Destruction (MAD). This doctrine rested on a chilling logic: if both sides possessed enough nuclear weapons to destroy each other completely, then neither side would risk initiating a conflict.



However, this balance was far from stable. It relied on assumptions of rationality, perfect communication, and controlled escalation—conditions that could easily break down in a crisis. The arms race also intensified paranoia and mistrust, as each side feared falling behind the other. The deployment of American nuclear missiles in Turkey and Italy, within striking distance of the Soviet Union, would later become a critical factor in Soviet decision-making regarding Cuba.

3. The Rise of Revolutionary Cuba and the Shift in the Western Hemisphere (1959–1960)

A decisive turning point in the Cold War occurred not in Europe, but in the Western Hemisphere. In 1959, Fidel Castro led a successful revolution that overthrew the authoritarian regime of Fulgencio Batista, a government closely aligned with the United States. Castro's rise to power initially did not signal immediate alignment with the Soviet Union, but his policies—particularly the nationalization of American-owned industries—quickly brought him into conflict with Washington.



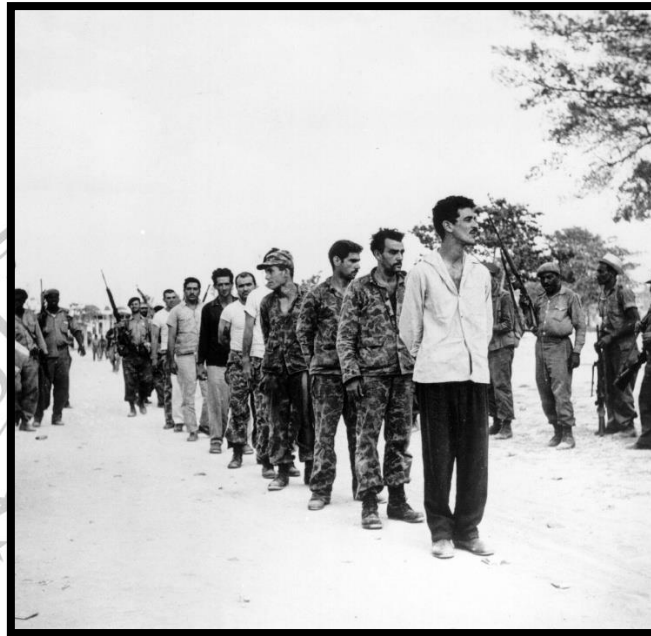
The United States responded with economic sanctions and diplomatic isolation, which pushed Cuba closer to the Soviet Union. By 1960, Cuba had established strong political, economic, and military ties with Moscow. For the Soviet Union, Cuba represented a rare opportunity to establish a strategic foothold in the Western Hemisphere, directly challenging American dominance. For the United States, however, the emergence of a communist state just 90 miles from its shores was perceived as an unacceptable threat.

This shift transformed Cuba into a focal point of Cold War tensions, setting the stage for direct confrontation between the two superpowers in a region traditionally dominated by the United States.



4. The Bay of Pigs Invasion and Its Consequences (1961)

In April 1961, the United States attempted to remove Castro from power through the Bay of Pigs Invasion, a covert operation planned by the CIA and approved by the Kennedy administration. The plan involved training and equipping Cuban exiles to invade the island and incite a popular uprising against Castro.



The operation was a catastrophic failure. The invading force was quickly overwhelmed by Cuban troops, and no widespread uprising occurred. The United States was publicly humiliated, and its credibility suffered significantly on the global stage. More importantly, the invasion had profound strategic consequences. It reinforced Castro's belief that the United States was determined to overthrow his government, prompting him to seek stronger military protection from the Soviet Union.

For Nikita Khrushchev, the failure of the invasion highlighted both American aggression and vulnerability. He perceived Kennedy as inexperienced and potentially weak, a miscalculation that would influence his later decisions. The Bay of Pigs did not remove Castro—it entrenched him and accelerated Cuba's transformation into a Soviet ally.

5. Operation Mongoose and Escalating Covert Conflict (1961–1962)

Following the failure of the Bay of Pigs, the United States intensified its efforts to destabilize Cuba through covert means. Operation Mongoose, launched in late 1961, was a comprehensive campaign of sabotage, espionage, and psychological warfare aimed at undermining Castro's regime. The operation included plans to disrupt Cuba's economy, incite internal dissent, and even assassinate Castro.

While many of these efforts failed or produced limited results, they had a significant psychological impact. From the Cuban and Soviet perspective, Operation Mongoose confirmed that the United States remained committed to regime change. The constant threat of invasion or subversion created a sense of urgency and vulnerability within the Cuban leadership.

This environment of escalating covert conflict contributed directly to the Soviet decision to deploy nuclear missiles in Cuba. For Khrushchev, placing missiles on the island was not only a strategic move but also a means of protecting an ally under constant threat from the United States.



6. The Turkish Missile Deployment (The Hidden Trigger)

One of the most critical yet often understated factors that led directly to the escalation of the Cuban Missile Crisis was the deployment of American nuclear missiles in Turkey. In the late 1950s, as part of its broader strategy to contain Soviet influence and reinforce its commitments to NATO allies, the United States stationed Jupiter intermediate-range ballistic missiles in Turkey, a country that bordered the Soviet Union. These missiles were capable of delivering nuclear warheads deep into Soviet territory within a very short timeframe, drastically reducing warning times and placing key Soviet cities and military installations under immediate threat.

From the American perspective, this deployment was a logical extension of its deterrence strategy. The United States had already positioned nuclear weapons across Europe, including in Italy and the United Kingdom, as part of a network designed to counter Soviet conventional superiority and reassure allies of American protection. Turkey, given its geographic proximity to the Soviet Union and its strategic importance within NATO, became a natural location for forward deployment. The missiles were intended to strengthen deterrence by signalling that any Soviet aggression would be met with swift and devastating retaliation.

However, from the Soviet perspective, the deployment of these missiles was deeply provocative and fundamentally destabilizing. To Soviet leadership, particularly Nikita Khrushchev, the presence of American nuclear weapons so close to Soviet borders represented a direct and unacceptable threat. It created a strategic imbalance in which the United States

possessed the ability to launch a near-instantaneous nuclear strike, while the Soviet Union lacked an equivalent capability in the Western Hemisphere. This asymmetry was not merely military—it was psychological and political, reinforcing a perception of vulnerability and encirclement.

The Turkish missile deployment also carried symbolic weight. It was seen by Moscow as evidence of American willingness to project power aggressively and to place nuclear weapons in sensitive regions without regard for Soviet security concerns. This perception was compounded by the broader context of the Cold War, including the United States' global network of alliances and its interventions in various regions. To Soviet leadership, the missiles in Turkey were not an isolated development, but part of a larger pattern of strategic pressure.

By 1962, the situation had reached a point where Khrushchev sought a decisive response. The idea of deploying Soviet nuclear missiles in Cuba emerged as a direct counterbalance to the American missiles in Turkey. If the United States could position nuclear weapons near Soviet territory, then the Soviet Union would do the same in the Western Hemisphere. This was not only about achieving strategic parity, but also about reshaping the psychological dynamics of the Cold War. Placing missiles in Cuba would force the United States to confront the same vulnerability that the Soviet Union had been experiencing.

The decision to deploy missiles in Cuba was therefore not a sudden or irrational act, but a



calculated move rooted in the logic of Cold War competition. It was intended to deter further American aggression, protect the Cuban regime, and demonstrate Soviet resolve on the global stage. However, this calculation was deeply flawed. It underestimated the intensity of the American response and the extent to which the United States would perceive the deployment as an existential threat.

In this sense, the Turkish missile deployment can be understood as a hidden trigger of the Cuban Missile Crisis. It did not cause the crisis on its own, but it created the conditions that made Soviet escalation seem both necessary and justified from Moscow's perspective. It transformed the crisis from a one-sided act of aggression into a confrontation shaped by mutual fear, competing perceptions, and a dangerous cycle of action and reaction.

By the time ExComm is convened on October 16, 1962, this underlying dynamic remains largely invisible to the American public but is central to Soviet decision-making. The missiles in Cuba are not just weapons—they are a message, a response, and a challenge. And unless this deeper context is understood, the risk of miscalculation only grows, pushing both superpowers closer to a conflict neither truly seeks, yet neither can easily avoid.

7. Khrushchev's Strategic Gamble: The Decision to Deploy Missiles (1962)



In 1962, Khrushchev made one of the most consequential decisions of the Cold War: to secretly deploy nuclear missiles in Cuba. This decision was driven by multiple factors. Strategically, it aimed to counterbalance the United States' nuclear advantage and the presence of American missiles in Turkey and Italy. Politically, it sought to demonstrate Soviet strength and resolve, particularly in the face of perceived American aggression.

The operation, carried out in secrecy, involved the transportation of missiles, warheads, and thousands of Soviet troops to Cuba. Construction of missile sites began rapidly, with the goal of making them operational before the United States could respond. Khrushchev believed that

the United States would not detect the deployment until it was too late, allowing the Soviet Union to alter the strategic balance without immediate confrontation.

However, this calculation underestimated American intelligence capabilities and the political implications of such a move. The deployment of nuclear weapons in Cuba represented a direct and unprecedented challenge to the United States, one that could not go unanswered.



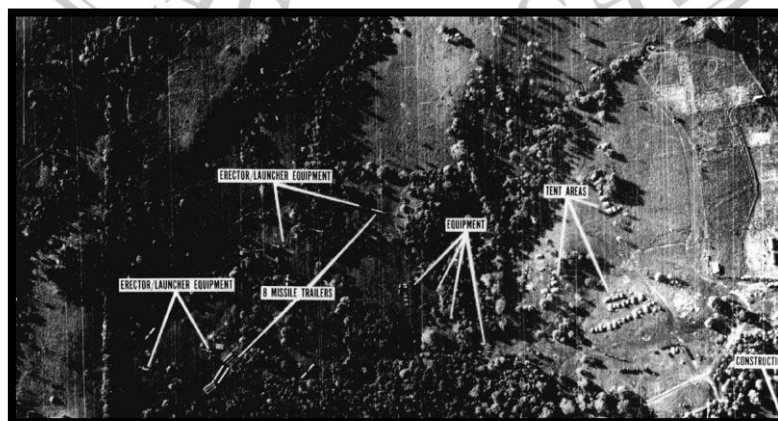
8. Discovery: U-2 Reconnaissance and the Beginning of the Crisis (October 14–16, 1962)

The final trigger of the crisis came on October 14, 1962, when a U-2 reconnaissance aircraft captured photographic evidence of Soviet missile installations under construction in Cuba. The images revealed launch sites for medium-range ballistic missiles capable of striking much of the continental United States.



On October 16, President Kennedy was briefed on the findings, marking the official beginning of the Cuban Missile Crisis and the formation of ExComm. The discovery transformed a hidden strategic manoeuvre into an immediate and visible threat. The United States now faced a situation in which nuclear weapons were being positioned within striking distance, with uncertain timelines for their completion and deployment.

At this moment, the freeze date of this committee—the world stands on the edge of a decision. The missiles are not yet fully operational, but time is rapidly running out. The United States must act, yet every possible action carries the risk of escalation. The choices made from this point forward will determine whether the crisis is resolved through strategy and restraint, or whether it spirals into a conflict that reshapes the course of human history.



This is where your committee begins.

Chronological Timeline of Events Leading to October 16, 1962

- **March 5, 1946 – Iron Curtain Speech:**
Winston Churchill declares the division of Europe between East and West, marking the ideological beginning of the Cold War and setting the tone for long-term superpower rivalry.
- **June 24, 1948 – May 12, 1949 – Berlin Blockade:**
The Soviet Union blocks access to West Berlin; the U.S. responds with the Berlin Airlift. This establishes a pattern of brinkmanship without direct war.
- **August 29, 1949 – Soviet Atomic Bomb Test:**
The USSR successfully tests its first nuclear weapon, ending U.S. nuclear monopoly and triggering a full-scale arms race.
- **April 4, 1949 – Formation of NATO:**
A collective defence alliance is formed by Western nations, formalizing opposition to Soviet expansion.
- **May 14, 1955 – Formation of Warsaw Pact:**
The Soviet Union creates its own alliance bloc, deepening the division of the world into two opposing camps.
- **January 1, 1959 – Cuban Revolution:**
Fidel Castro overthrows Batista and establishes a socialist regime, bringing communism into the Western Hemisphere.
- **1960 – U.S.-Cuba Relations Collapse:**
The U.S. imposes sanctions after Cuba nationalizes American assets, pushing Cuba into a stronger alliance with the Soviet Union.
- **April 17–20, 1961 – Bay of Pigs Invasion:**
A CIA-backed invasion fails disastrously, strengthening Castro and convincing Cuba that a U.S. invasion is imminent.
- **June 4, 1961 – Vienna Summit:**
John F. Kennedy meets Nikita Khrushchev; tensions worsen as no agreements are reached and Khrushchev perceives Kennedy as weak.
- **Late 1961 – Operation Mongoose Begins:**
The U.S. launches covert sabotage operations against Cuba, reinforcing Cuban and Soviet fears of regime change.
- **1961–1962 – U.S. Missiles Deployed in Turkey:**
The United States installs nuclear missiles near Soviet borders, creating strategic imbalance and provoking Soviet response.
- **May 1962 – Soviet Decision to Deploy Missiles in Cuba:**
Nikita Khrushchev secretly authorizes missile deployment to counter U.S. advantage and protect Cuba.
- **July–September 1962 – Soviet Military Build-up in Cuba:**
Missiles, troops, and equipment are transported secretly to Cuba; construction of launch sites begins.
- **September 4, 1962 – U.S. Warning to USSR:**
The U.S. publicly warns against offensive weapons in Cuba; the USSR denies any such deployment.
- **October 14, 1962 – U-2 Reconnaissance Discovery:**
U.S. spy planes capture photographic evidence of Soviet missile installations under construction in Cuba.

- October 16, 1962 – Formation of ExComm:**
 President John F. Kennedy is briefed and convenes ExComm. The crisis formally begins as the U.S. confronts an immediate nuclear threat with limited time to act.



Message from the Executive Board

Delegates,

“Let us never negotiate out of fear. But let us never fear to negotiate.”

— John F. Kennedy

What you are about to enter is not a debate, it is a threshold.

On October 16, 1962, a handful of individuals found themselves confronting a reality no generation had ever faced before: the possibility that human civilization could end not through gradual decline, but through a sequence of decisions taken in a single room. That room was ExComm. And now, it is yours.

This committee is built on tension, not just between nations, but between choices. Every path before you carries risk. Every delay carries consequence. Every assumption you make could either stabilize the situation... or accelerate its collapse. The presence of Soviet missiles in Cuba is not merely a strategic challenge, it is a direct compression of time, space, and margin for error. The world has moved from rivalry to immediacy. And you are now operating inside that immediacy.

You will find that clarity is a luxury you do not possess. Intelligence will be incomplete. Advice will be conflicting. Pressure will come from every direction - military, political, psychological. Some voices will demand action. Others will warn against it. And in the middle of that noise, you will have to decide which risks you are willing to take, and which you are not.

We expect you to approach this committee not as performers, but as decision-makers. Your role is not to dominate through volume, but through precision. When you speak, it should be because you have something that changes the course of the room. When you act, it should be because you understand the implications of that action, not just immediately, but several steps ahead.

This committee rewards those who can think in layers. Military decisions must consider diplomatic fallout. Diplomatic moves must account for military vulnerability. Domestic pressures must be balanced against international perception. Nothing exists in isolation. The strength of your strategy will depend on your ability to connect these layers into a coherent, believable approach.

At the same time, understand that control is fragile. Situations may escalate beyond your intention. Reactions may not align with expectations. The crisis will evolve, and so must you. Adaptability will not be an advantage; it will be a necessity.

We also urge you to remember that power is not only expressed through force. Sometimes, the most significant move is the one that prevents escalation rather than triggers it. Sometimes

restraint is not weakness, but calculation. As history has shown, the line between strength and destruction is often thinner than it appears.

This committee is not about finding perfect solutions, because none exist. It is about navigating imperfect ones with awareness and responsibility. It is about understanding that leadership is not defined by certainty, but by the ability to act despite its absence.

As the Executive Board, our role is to challenge you, to create an environment where your decisions matter, where your strategies are tested, and where your ability to operate under pressure is pushed to its limits. We are not looking for idealism without grounding, nor aggression without purpose. We are looking for credibility. For intent. For decisions that feel real.

By the time this committee concludes, outcomes will have been shaped, trajectories altered, and consequences set into motion. Whether those consequences lead to stability or catastrophe will depend entirely on how you choose to proceed.

There is no script for what comes next.
Only choices.

And now, those choices belong to you.

Warm regards,

The Executive Board

Executive Committee of the National Security Council (ExComm)

ClaroMUN 2026

Position Paper

A position paper is a pre-committee document- that is sent to the Executive Board. It shows your stance on the given agenda, while also giving an overview of the problem and solutions for it. The format to be preferably followed is:

- 1) Statement of the Problem
- 2) Policy/Stance on the Agenda at Hand
- 3) Solutions
- 4) Conclusion

The last date for the submission of position papers is 21st July, 11: 59 P.M. All position papers and other documents and paperwork must be mailed to excomm.claromun26@gmail.com. This shall be the official e-mail ID of this committee for all paperwork.



Citations:

- John F. Kennedy Presidential Library and Museum – Cuban Missile Crisis documents, ExComm transcripts, secret recordings (<https://www.jfklibrary.org>)
- U.S. Department of State – *Foreign Relations of the United States (FRUS)*, 1961–1963, Vol. XI (<https://history.state.gov>)
- Central Intelligence Agency – Intelligence assessments, U-2 imagery, crisis briefings (<https://www.cia.gov/readingroom>)
- National Security Archive – Declassified Cold War and Cuba crisis documents (<https://nsarchive.gwu.edu>)
- United Nations – Security Council debates and Adlai Stevenson confrontation records (<https://www.un.org>)
- National Archives and Records Administration – Official Cold War documents and defence communications (<https://www.archives.gov>)
- Library of Congress – Cold War manuscripts, speeches, and primary documents (<https://www.loc.gov>)
- Wilson Center – Soviet and Eastern Bloc archival insights (<https://www.wilsoncenter.org>)
- Nuclear Threat Initiative – Analysis of nuclear doctrines, missile capabilities, and Cold War deterrence (<https://www.nti.org>)
- Atomic Heritage Foundation – Educational material on nuclear weapons development and strategy (<https://www.atomicheritage.org>)
- BBC – Cuban Missile Crisis timelines and explanatory articles (<https://www.bbc.co.uk/history>)
- Council on Foreign Relations – Strategic context and Cold War analysis (<https://www.cfr.org>)
- The New York Times – Archival reporting (October 1962 crisis coverage)
- The Washington Post – Retrospective Cold War analysis and investigative features
- Time Magazine – Contemporary and retrospective coverage of Cold War crises
- Encyclopaedia Britannica – Verified historical summaries of Cold War events

Books & Scholarly Works Referenced:

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Conclusion

As you reach the end of this study guide, what should remain with you is not just information—but perspective. The Cuban Missile Crisis was not merely a geopolitical confrontation; it was a moment where human judgment stood between survival and catastrophe. It was a crisis shaped not only by power and strategy, but by fear, miscalculation, and the burden of leadership under unimaginable pressure.

This committee is designed to place you inside that reality. You are not stepping into a structured debate with predictable outcomes—you are entering a space where clarity is limited, time is scarce, and consequences are immediate. The situation you inherit is already unstable. Missiles have been discovered. Intentions remain uncertain. Options are few, and none are without cost. Every decision you take will push the crisis in a direction—towards de-escalation, controlled confrontation, or irreversible conflict.

What this guide has shown you is that this moment did not arise suddenly. It was built over years—through rivalry, strategic imbalance, failed diplomacy, and mutual distrust. From the early fractures of the Cold War to the rise of Cuba as a Soviet ally, from covert operations to nuclear posturing, each step narrowed the space for peaceful resolution. By the time this committee begins, the world is no longer moving toward crisis—it is already within it.

Your role now is to navigate that crisis with awareness and intent.

You will be required to evaluate not just what is possible, but what is *sustainable*. A military strike may remove the immediate threat, but at what cost? A diplomatic approach may preserve stability, but can it act quickly enough? Intelligence may guide your choices, but can you trust it fully? These are the tensions you must balance—constantly, carefully, and under pressure.

Understand that in this environment, there are no perfect decisions—only informed ones. Leadership here is not about certainty; it is about judgment. It is about recognizing the weight of each action before it is taken, and the ripple effects it will create long after. It is about knowing when to assert power, and when to restrain it.

Above all, remember this: the outcome of this crisis will not be determined by chance—it will be determined by you.

Every directive issued, every stance taken, every moment of hesitation or resolve will shape the trajectory of events. Whether the situation stabilizes or escalates, whether the world steps back or moves forward into conflict, will depend entirely on how you choose to act within this room.

This committee is not about recreating history—it is about testing your ability to operate within it.

The moment has arrived.
The stakes are absolute.

And now, the responsibility is yours. **History will remember what you do here.**